Psychology and Aging

Age Differences in Dating App Motivations: Implications for Well-Being in Older Adulthood

Rong Liang and Phoebe E. Bailey

Online First Publication, April 16, 2026. https://dx.doi.org/10.1037/pag0000985

CITATION
Liang, R., & Bailey, P. E. (2026). Age differences in dating app motivations: Implications for well-being in older adulthood. *Psychology and Aging*. Advance online publication. https://dx.doi.org/10.1037/pag0000985

AMERICAN PSYCHOLOGICAL ASSOCIATION

Psychology and Aging

© 2026 The Author(s)
ISSN: 0882-7974

https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000985

Age Differences in Dating App Motivations: Implications for Well-Being in Older Adulthood

Rong Liang and Phoebe E. Bailey
Graduate School of Health, University of Technology Sydney

Dating apps are increasingly used across the adult lifespan, yet little is known about age-related differences in dating app motivations and the links to psychological well-being. In this cross-sectional study, 301 dating app users (18–86 years; $M = 52.4$, $SD = 16.5$) self-reported five motivations (social approval, relationship seeking, sexual experience, socializing, and entertainment), as well as life satisfaction, loneliness, and depressive and anxiety symptoms. Older age among dating app users was associated with lesser sexual experience, relationship seeking, and social approval motivations but higher socializing motivation, with no age differences in entertainment motivation. Greater social approval motivation predicted higher levels of loneliness among older adults but not young adults. This suggests that, among older dating app users, greater loneliness may increase the desire to gain social approval, and/or seeking social approval in older age may increase loneliness.

Public Significance Statement
This study shows that older adults use dating apps for different reasons than younger users, placing greater emphasis on socializing and less on sexual experiences, relationship seeking, and social approval. Motivation to gain social approval is associated with greater loneliness in older dating app users, highlighting the importance of designing age-friendly dating platforms and interventions that promote meaningful social connection rather than external validation.

Keywords: dating app motivations, social approval, older adults, loneliness, well-being

Supplemental materials: https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000985.supp

Dating apps have introduced new ways to connect with potential romantic or sexual partners, allowing users to bypass many of the geographical, social, or physical barriers that may otherwise hinder relationship formation (Timmermans & Courtois, 2018). This may be particularly valuable for older adults who often face unique challenges in dating, including reduced mobility, smaller social circles, and persistent societal stereotypes around aging and romance (Vandeweerd et al., 2016). Almost 39% of heterosexual couples in the U.S. meet online (Rosenfeld et al., 2019), and one in four adults aged 50–64 reported knowing someone who met and fell in love online (Smith & Duggan, 2013). In 2019, one fifth of people aged 55–64 and 13% of those aged 65 and older had experimented with online dating (Vogels & Anderson, 2020). Engagement with online technology for social purposes is also increasing among older adults (Hülür & Macdonald, 2020). However, there remains a limited understanding of age-related differences in motivations to use dating apps, and few studies have examined how dating app motivations influence psychological well-being across the adult lifespan (e.g., Stevic et al., 2025). The present descriptive study aimed to fill these gaps in the literature by examining how dating app motivations vary in an adult lifespan sample and how these motivations influence mental health outcomes including loneliness, life satisfaction, and depressive and anxiety symptoms.

Age-Related Differences in Dating App Motivations

Understanding the motivations underlying dating app use is critical for evaluating age-related differences in how these platforms

Gizem Hülür served as action editor.
Rong Liang https://orcid.org/0009-0004-2575-7859
Phoebe E. Bailey https://orcid.org/0000-0001-8960-1897
Portions of this research were presented at the Sydney Post Graduate Psychology Conference, Australia, in 2024. Data and findings have not been published elsewhere or posted publicly in any form prior to journal submission. Data are available on the Open Science Framework at https://osf.io/hq23u/?view_only=3bbc13bc8b2f4fdaa473608ac9647d69. The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Open Access funding provided by University of Technology Sydney: This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License (CC BY 4.0; https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0). This license permits copying and redistributing the work in any medium or format, as well as adapting the material for any purpose, even commercially.

Rong Liang played a lead role in conceptualization, data curation, formal analysis, methodology, project administration, validation, visualization, and writing–original draft. Phoebe E. Bailey played a lead role in supervision and writing–review and editing and an equal role in conceptualization, formal analysis, and methodology.

Correspondence concerning this article should be addressed to Rong Liang, Graduate School of Health, University of Technology Sydney, P.O. Box 123, Broadway, Sydney, NSW 2007, Australia. Email: patliang817@gmail.com

may affect mental health. The uses and gratifications theory suggests that individuals engage with media to satisfy specific psychological or social needs, which subsequently influence their behaviors and outcomes (Ruggiero, 2000). Supporting this view, a systematic review of 70 studies showed that people engage with dating apps for a wide variety of reasons, including forming long-term relationships, entertainment, validation, and socializing, indicating that their use extends well beyond casual sex (Castro & Barrada, 2020). More recently, Stevic et al. (2025) proposed that these diverse purposes can be grouped into two overarching categories: relational motives (aimed at forming short- or long-term partnerships) and social motives (aimed at gaining validation or attention from others). For example, social motives are reinforced by app features such as "likes" and "matches," which encourage users to seek approval and affirm their desirability.

Building on uses and gratifications theory (Ruggiero, 2000), Timmermans and De Caluwé's (2017) Tinder Motives Scale includes 13 distinct motives for using Tinder among primarily single, heterosexual young adults ($M_{age} = 27$). In further research, Sumter et al. (2017) conducted an exploratory factor analysis and identified six key motivations among emerging adult dating app users ($M_{age} = 24$). The present study selected five overlapping motivations from these two scales to investigate age-related differences in dating app use: (1) social approval (seeking validation from others or "social motives"), (2) relationship seeking (e.g., to fall in love or find a future spouse), (3) sexual experience (e.g., to find a one night stand or live out a sexual fantasy), (4) socializing (e.g., to make new friends or expand social networks), and (5) entertainment (e.g., using the app for fun or passing time when feeling bored).

Although entertainment does not fall within one of Stevic et al.'s (2025) social or relational motives, it was one of the two strongest motives for using Tinder among the 13 assessed in Timmermans and De Caluwé's (2017) study. The authors pointed out that younger adults are using Tinder not only for relational or sexual intimacy but also to pass the time and relieve boredom. As midlife responsibilities such as work and child-raising decrease, there is more time available for leisure as people age (Bonsang & Klein, 2012). A review also suggests that older adults may experience greater boredom (An et al., 2023). We therefore expected that, relative to younger adults, older adults would report greater motivation to use online dating apps for entertainment purposes.

According to socioemotional selectivity theory (Carstensen, 2021; Carstensen et al., 1999, 2020), individuals prioritize different social goals depending on their future time perspective (i.e., perception of the amount of time one has left in life). Younger adults, with an expansive future time perspective (i.e., the perception that one has a long and open-ended future ahead), are more likely to prioritize goals that enhance future opportunities, such as forming new social connections or acquiring new information. In contrast, older adults with a limited future time perspective (i.e., the perception that time remaining in life is limited) focus on goals that are emotionally meaningful in the present such as maintaining close social connections and avoiding potentially negative interactions with strangers (Carstensen, 2021). These shifts occur not because older adults lose interest in social connection but because they prioritize interactions that offer predictability and maintain emotional well-being. This means that older adults become increasingly selective about who they interact with. Ongoing romantic companionship offers more emotional closeness and stability, which are outcomes that older adults increasingly value. In contrast, motivations such as casual sex or broad socializing carry uncertainty associated with interacting with new social partners and may be less favored by older adults.

In addition to a preference for close social relationships, older adults tend to prefer low-arousal positive emotional states like calmness or relaxation. This may reduce their motivation to seek high-arousal activities such as sexual experiences (Scheibe et al., 2013). Further evidence for this preference is supported by a study of 5,434 dating app users aged 20–95 years. It showed that dating app users aged 60 and older valued sexual attraction less than younger users (Menkin et al., 2015). In addition, data from the Berlin Aging Study II involving people aged 60–82 years revealed that sexual thoughts, defined as wishes for sexual activity and physical intimacy, declined slightly with age (Kolodziejczak et al., 2019). These studies suggest that older age may be associated with lesser sexual experience motivation.

The dual-process model of developmental regulation (Brandtstädter & Greve, 1994; Brandtstädter & Rothermund, 2002) offers another useful framework for understanding how individuals adapt their goals in response to the experience of declining personal resources in later life. According to this model, adaptation to age-related changes or constraints occurs through two main coping strategies: "assimilative" and "accommodative" coping. Assimilative activities include active efforts to change or compensate for one's situation to meet personal goals (e.g., finding a romantic partner, gaining social status). This strategy is typically used when individuals believe their goals are still attainable. When this is no longer feasible due to age or limitations, individuals shift toward accommodative strategies, which involve adjusting one's goals and expectations. As people age, accommodative strategies are proposed to become more dominant (Brandtstädter et al., 2010). This might mean increasingly investing in goals that are considered attainable and emotionally meaningful (e.g., relationship seeking and companionship) while disengaging from goals that involve high uncertainty or limited control (e.g., sexual exploration and broad socializing). At the same time, older adults show a motivational shift from egocentric-individualistic goals toward pursuing more ego-transcending strivings (Brandtstädter et al., 2010; Isaacowitz et al., 2021). This shift toward ego transcendence suggests that older adults draw meaning from intrinsic values and authenticity rather than external validation. Consistent with this idea, older adults have also demonstrated less concern with the expectations and opinions of other people (Tornstam, 1997). Taken together, existing empirical data and motivational theories of adult development suggest that, relative to younger adults, older adults may be less motivated by social approval and casual sexual experience or broad socializing but more motivated by entertainment and relationship seeking, when using dating apps.

Dating App Motivations and Psychological Well-Being

Research examining how different motivations for using dating apps relate to well-being is limited, particularly among older adults. Existing studies mainly focus on younger users. For example, young dating app users (18–29 years) who reported greater relationship seeking or sexual experience motivation also reported greater sadness and/or anxiety (Her & Timmermans, 2021). However, both relational motives were simultaneously associated with greater joviality. Another study involving young adults (18–40 years) found that relational goals (i.e., long-term dating, establishing a committed relationship, or finding a life/marriage partner) were not associated with loneliness or life satisfaction (Stevic et al., 2025). The authors suggested that the quality of subsequent interactions that follow

from app use might be more important than relationship seeking for young adult's loneliness and life satisfaction. However, this assertion was not directly examined. In addition, there is no previous research examining motivations and well-being among older dating app users. Studies have, however, examined older adults' use of social media. A review indicated that older adults with greater life satisfaction were less likely to use social media specifically for meeting new people (Cotten et al., 2021). This suggests that greater relational motives among older dating app users may be associated with reduced psychological well-being.

Motivation to use dating apps for entertainment purposes has been associated with higher levels of both anxiety and joviality among young adults (Her & Timmermans, 2021). Among older adults, lesser use of social media as a form of distraction is associated with greater satisfaction with life (Cotten et al., 2021). To the extent that using social media for distraction is akin to using dating apps for entertainment purposes, greater entertainment motivation among older dating app users may be associated with poorer well-being. On the other hand, for young dating app users, greater motivation for social approval has been correlated with greater loneliness (Stevic et al., 2025) as well as greater sadness and anxiety (Her & Timmermans, 2021). If older adults as a group are less motivated by social approval than young adults, they may be protected from these negative effects on well-being.

The Present Study

The present study aimed to examine two key research questions: (1) Are there age-related differences in dating app motivations, including social approval, relationship seeking, sexual experience, socializing, and entertainment? and (2) How are age-related differences in motivations to use dating apps associated with well-being? To examine well-being, we selected well-validated measures of life satisfaction, loneliness, and depressive and anxiety symptoms. Based on socioemotional selectivity theory (Carstensen, 2021; Carstensen et al., 1999) and the dual-process model of developmental regulation (Brandtstädter & Rothermund, 2002), as well as existing research, we hypothesized that older adults would report stronger motivations for relationship seeking and entertainment but weaker motivations for socializing, sexual experience, and social approval compared to younger adults (H1). We expected that, among older dating app users, greater motivation for relationship seeking would be associated with poorer psychological well-being, that is, lesser life satisfaction (H2a), and greater loneliness (H2b), depressive symptoms (H2c), and anxiety symptoms (H2d). We also expected that, among older dating app users, greater motivation for entertainment would be associated with poorer psychological well-being, that is, lesser life satisfaction (H2e), and greater loneliness (H2f), depressive symptoms (H2g), and anxiety symptoms (H2h). Among younger dating app users, we hypothesized an association between greater social approval motivation and poorer psychological well-being, that is, lesser life satisfaction (H3a), and greater loneliness (H3b), depressive symptoms (H3c), and anxiety symptoms (H3d).

Method

Transparency and Openness

The hypotheses and analytic plan were not preregistered. We report how we determined our sample size, all data exclusions, all manipulations, and all measures used in the study. To support reproducibility, the deidentified data set and all supporting materials, including consent form and information sheet, are available on the Open Science Framework (Liang, 2025; https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/9AHPY). No analytic code was used in the data analysis. All analyses were conducted using point-and-click procedures in Jamovi Version 2.6.26.0. This research was approved by the university's human research ethics committee, and all participants provided informed consent. We followed American Psychological Association Journal Article Reporting Standards where applicable.

Participants

Participants ($N = 302$) were recruited through Prolific in July and August 2023, with one data set excluded due to an invalid age entry, leaving 301 valid cases (49.8% men, 48.5% women, 3% nonbinary, and 2% prefer not to say). Ages ranged from 18 to 86 years ($M = 52.4$, $SD = 16.5$). See Table 1 for additional participant demographic descriptive data. The inclusion criteria were (a) aged 18 or older, (b) current users of any dating apps, and (c) residents of Australia, the United States, Canada, or the United Kingdom. In addition, an attention check item was embedded within the survey to ensure participants were not responding randomly. The item instructed participants to "Please type the Number 7." All participants responded correctly to this attention check item. Participants were compensated GBP3.75 (or the equivalent in their local currency) for their time. A G*Power analysis indicated that a multiple regression with 11 predictors (i.e., age, the five

Table 1
Participant Demographic Descriptive Data (N = 301)

Demographic information	*N* (%)
Sexual orientation	
Heterosexual	228 (75.7)
Bisexual	39 (13.0)
Homosexual	26 (8.6)
Pansexual	6 (2.0)
Asexual	2 (0.7)
Ethnicity	
White/Caucasian	221 (73.4)
Asian	15 (5.0)
Hispanic/Latino	11 (3.7)
Black/African American	45 (15.0)
Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander	1 (0.3)
Other	8 (2.7)
Education	
Did not complete high school	5 (1.7)
High school or equivalent	92 (30.6)
Bachelor's degree	128 (42.5)
Master's degree	68 (22.6)
Doctorate	8 (2.7)
Employment	
Full time	150 (49.8)
Part time	69 (22.9)
Unemployed	34 (11.3)
Retired	48 (15.9)
Relationship status	
Single	88 (29.2)
Casual dating	54 (17.9)
Domestic relationship	53 (17.6)
Married	47 (15.6)
Divorced/widowed	59 (19.6)

dating app motivations, and five interactions between age and motivation) requires 290 participants to detect a small-to-medium effect ($f^2 = 0.06$; $\alpha = .05$) with 80% power (Faul et al., 2009). The study was approved by the Human Research Ethics Committee of the University of Technology Sydney (Ethics Approval ID: M–4–2023-11-8).

Measures and Procedure

Participants provided informed consent online, completed demographic questions, and filled out the questionnaires anonymously through Qualtrics. The order of the questionnaires was randomized for each participant. Participants also completed an additional questionnaire for a separate study not reported here.

Dating App Usage

Participants provided information on their dating app usage, including duration of use (less than 1 month to over a year), daily usage (less than 10 min to more than an hour), number of weekly interactions (fewer than five to more than 15), in-person meetings (i.e., "Have you engaged in in-person meetings with individuals you have connected with through dating apps?"), and overall satisfaction with the app (extremely dissatisfied to extremely satisfied).

Life Satisfaction

The Satisfaction with Life Scale (Diener et al., 1985) is a five-item questionnaire using a 7-point Likert scale to assess overall life satisfaction, with higher total scores indicating greater satisfaction. The Satisfaction with Life Scale has demonstrated strong validity and reliability across various populations (Pavot & Diener, 2008). Recent research involving older adults reported excellent internal consistency, with McDonald's omega of .92 (M_{age} = 69.5; Dominguez-Vergara et al., 2024). In the current sample, reliability was excellent (α = .91).

Loneliness

The three-item Loneliness Scale (Hughes et al., 2004) is a brief measure assessing perceived loneliness, with responses rated on a 3-point scale ranging from 1 (*hardly ever*) to 3 (*often*), where higher total scores indicate greater loneliness. This three-item version demonstrated acceptable reliability (α = .72) in a sample of 2,182 adults aged 50–67 years (Hughes et al., 2004). In the current sample, reliability was strong (α = .84).

Depressive and Anxiety Symptoms

The Depression Anxiety Stress Scales–21 (Lovibond & Lovibond, 1995) is a 21-item self-report questionnaire that was used to assess the severity of depressive (seven items) and anxiety (seven items) symptoms over the past week. Each item is rated on a 4-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (*did not apply to me at all*) to 4 (*applied to me very much or most of the time*), with higher total scores indicating greater symptom severity. The Depression Anxiety Stress Scales–21 has demonstrated strong reliability for the depression (α = .88) and anxiety (α = .90) subscales in a sample aged 18–91 years (Henry & Crawford, 2005). In the current sample, reliability was strong for the depressive subscale (α = .94) and the anxiety subscale (α = .88).

Motivation for Using Dating Apps

Five subscales from the Tinder Motives Scale (Timmermans & De Caluwé, 2017) were used to assess participants' motivations for using dating apps, including social approval (six items), relationship seeking (five items), sexual experience (six items), socializing (four items), and entertainment (seven items). The final questionnaire consisted of 28 items rated on a 7-point Likert scale (1 = *strongly disagree* and 7 = *strongly agree*). Each motive subscale score was calculated by averaging the scores on each item for that subscale, with higher average scores indicating stronger endorsement of each type of motivation. The Tinder Motives Scale has demonstrated good to excellent internal consistency, with Cronbach's α values for the subscales used in the present study ranging from .85 to .93 (Timmermans & De Caluwé, 2017). In the current sample, reliability was strong for the social approval (α = .94), relationship seeking (α = .91), sexual experience (α = .92), socializing (α = .80), and entertainment (α = .93) subscales.

Data Cleaning and Analysis

Data were analyzed using *jamovi* (Version 2.6.26; The jamovi project, 2025). Prior to analysis, data were screened for outliers. Following the method used in our lab, values more than 3 *SD*s from the age group mean were adjusted to the mean ± 3 *SD*s. This resulted in adjustment of one data point among participants aged 18–39 years, seven data points among those aged 40–64 years, and six data points among those aged 65+. Spearman's rank-order correlation assessed relationships between age, dating motivations, and well-being measures. Multiple linear regressions were conducted for each well-being outcome with age and the five motivations, as well as the interaction between age and each motivation, as predictors. All predictors were centered to control for multicollinearity. Significant interactions were followed up with a simple effects analysis. Each regression was reanalyzed controlling for relationship status, with "in a relationship" (domestic relationship or married) coded as 1 and "not in a relationship" (single, casual dating, and divorced/widowed) coded as 0 (see Supplemental Table S1 to S4).

Results

Dating App Use

Descriptive statistics for dating app use are presented in Table 2. Correlations between these dating app use variables, motivation subscales, and well-being measures are available in the Supplemental Tables S5 to S6.

Does Age Correlate With Dating App Motivations and Well-Being?

We hypothesized that older adults would report stronger motivations for relationship seeking and entertainment but weaker motivations for socializing, sexual experiences, and social approval compared to younger adults (H1). As shown in Table 3, we found partial support for this hypothesis. Older age was associated with reporting lesser sexual experience (p = .036), relationship seeking (p = .003), and social approval (p = .024) motivations and greater socializing motivation (p = .006). Age was not associated with entertainment motivation. In addition, older age was associated with

Table 2
Dating App Use Descriptive Data (N = 301)

Dating app use	*N* (%)
Hours per day	
Up to 10 min	115 (38.2)
Up to 30 min	91 (30.2)
Up to 1 hr	61 (20.3)
More than 1 hr	34 (11.3)
Number of people interacted with per week	
5 or fewer	224 (74.4)
5–10	53 (17.6)
11–15	17 (5.6)
More than 15	7 (2.3)
In-person meetings	
Yes	232 (77.1)
No	69 (22.9)
Satisfaction with dating apps	
Extremely dissatisfied	32 (10.6)
Somewhat dissatisfied	87 (28.9)
Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied	67 (22.3)
Somewhat satisfied	102 (33.9)
Extremely satisfied	13 (4.3)

greater life satisfaction ($p < .001$) and lower levels of loneliness ($p < .001$), depressive symptoms ($p < .001$), and anxiety symptoms ($p < .001$).

Do Age and Dating App Motivations Predict Well-Being?

We expected that, among older dating app users, greater motivations for relationship seeking and entertainment would be associated with poorer psychological well-being (H2a–H2h). Among younger dating app users, we hypothesized an association between greater social approval motivation and poorer well-being (H3a–H3d).

Life Satisfaction

The overall model was significant, $F(11, 289) = 3.58$, $p < .001$, adjusted $R^2 = .09$. However, there was no interaction between age and relationship seeking nor between age and entertainment motivation (see Table 4). Therefore, H2a and H2e were not supported. In addition, there was no interaction between age and social approval motivation. Therefore, H3a was not supported. Rather, older age and greater social approval motivation independently predicted greater life satisfaction, controlling for the other predictors.

Loneliness

The overall model was significant, $F(11, 289) = 2.64$, $p = .003$, adjusted $R^2 = .06$. However, neither relationship seeking nor entertainment motivation predicted greater loneliness among older adults (see Table 5). Therefore, H2b and H2f were not supported. Loneliness was predicted by an interaction between age and social approval. As shown in Figure 1, simple effects analysis provided no evidence for an association between social approval motivation and loneliness among younger adults ($\beta = -0.16$, $p = .203$). Therefore, H3b was not supported. In contrast, among older adults, higher social approval motivation was associated with greater loneliness ($\beta = 0.28$, $p = .025$).

Depressive Symptoms

The overall model was significant, $F(11, 289) = 5.75$, $p < .001$, adjusted $R^2 = .15$. However, there was no interaction between age and relationship seeking nor between age and entertainment motivation (see Table 6). Therefore, H2c and H2g were not supported. In addition, there was no interaction between age and social approval motivation. Therefore, H3c was not supported. Only older age predicted fewer depressive symptoms, controlling for the other predictors.

Anxiety Symptoms

The overall model was significant, $F(11, 289) = 7.29$, $p < .001$, adjusted $R^2 = .19$. However, there was no interaction between age and relationship seeking nor between age and entertainment motivation. Therefore, H2d and H2h were not supported. In addition, there was no interaction between age and social approval motivation. Therefore, H3d was not supported. Instead, greater motivation for social approval, relationship seeking, and sexual experience predicted higher anxiety symptom scores, averaged across age (see Table 7).

Discussion

The present study aimed to examine age-related differences in dating app motivations and the association with psychological

Table 3
Correlation Matrix of Age, Well-Being Measures, and Dating App Motivations (N = 301)

Variable	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1. Age	—									
2. Life satisfaction	.29***	—								
3. Loneliness	−.23***	−.49***	—							
4. Depressive symptoms	−.33***	−.47***	.58***	—						
5. Anxiety symptoms	−.29***	−.23***	.44***	.65***	—					
6. Social approval	−.12*	.12*	.08	.05	.15**	—				
7. Relationship seeking	−.17**	−.00	.10	.11*	.12*	.07	—			
8. Sexual experience	−.12*	.04	.02	.11	.21***	.20***	−.25***	—		
9. Socializing	.16**	.13*	.01	.01	.14*	.14*	.07	.14*	—	
10. Entertainment	−.10	.12*	.08	.15**	.24***	.36***	−.13*	.37***	.47***	—
M	52.4	20.8	5.72	11.5	9.02	3.56	4.95	3.27	4.59	4.19
SD	16.50	7.45	1.79	5.02	3.66	1.10	1.35	1.68	1.27	1.43

* $p < .05$. ** $p < .01$. *** $p < .001$.

Table 4
Age and Dating Motivations as Predictors of Life Satisfaction

Predictor	β	95% CI		*B*	*p*
		LL	*UL*		
Age	0.30	0.18	0.41	0.13	**<.001**
Social approval	0.13	0.01	0.25	0.88	**.032**
Relationship seeking	0.02	−0.10	0.14	0.11	.747
Sexual experience	0.03	−0.10	0.15	0.13	.644
Socializing	0.02	−0.11	0.14	0.09	.806
Entertainment	0.07	−0.07	0.22	0.39	.311
Age × Social approval	−0.04	−0.15	0.07	−0.02	.501
Age × Relationship seek	−0.08	−0.20	0.03	−0.03	.158
Age × Sexual experience	−0.02	−0.14	0.11	0.00	.794
Age × Socializing	0.07	−0.06	0.19	0.02	.312
Age × Entertainment	−0.02	−0.16	0.12	−0.01	.791

Note. Significant values appear in bold. CI = confidence interval; *LL* = lower limit; *UL* = upper limit.

well-being in a cross-sectional sample of current dating app users aged 18–86 years. In line with H1, older dating app users reported lesser motivation for sexual experiences and social approval. However, contrary to H1, they were also less motivated by relationship seeking and more motivated by socializing. There was no evidence for an association between age and entertainment motivation. We found no support for the hypothesis that relationship seeking and entertainment would be associated with poorer well-being, that is, lesser life satisfaction (H2a, H2e), and greater loneliness (H2b, H2f), depressive symptoms (H2c, H2g), and anxiety symptoms (H2d, H2h), among older, but not younger, dating app users. We also found no support for an association between greater social approval motivation and poorer well-being, that is, lesser life satisfaction (H3a), and greater loneliness (H3b), depressive symptoms (H3c), and anxiety symptoms (H3d) among younger, but not older, dating app users. Rather, among older dating app users, greater motivation for social approval predicted higher levels of loneliness.

Age Differences in Motivations for Dating App Use

An older age among dating app users was associated with less motivation for relationship seeking and more motivation for socializing. This pattern may reflect a shift in priorities with age, where expanding social networks becomes more important than pursuing new romantic partnerships. This finding was unexpected, given that both socioemotional selectivity theory (Carstensen et al., 1999) and the dual-process model of developmental regulation (Brandtstädter & Greve, 1994; Brandtstädter & Rothermund, 2002) propose that older adults will prioritize close social relationships and reduce interactions with new and uncertain social partners who may present risks to well-being. However, the current findings are consistent with broader research on older adults' internet use, which highlights their tendency to use online platforms as a means of reducing loneliness and expanding social networks rather than pursuing romantic or sexual goals (Hülür & Macdonald, 2020; Kolodziejczak et al., 2019; Menkin et al., 2015; Stephure et al., 2009). For many older individuals, especially those who have retired or experienced the loss of a partner, there may be fewer offline opportunities to meet new people, making dating apps a practical avenue for social engagement. In addition, previous experiences with long-term relationships (e.g., divorce and grief) may lessen interest in pursuing new romantic relationships.

Entertainment motivation was rated moderately high across the sample, in line with previous research (Timmermans & De Caluwé, 2017). However, we did not find evidence to support the prediction that older dating app users would report greater entertainment motivation. This suggests that even if older adults have more time for leisure activities (Bonsang & Klein, 2012) and experience greater boredom (An et al., 2023), this does not appear to be associated with motivation to use dating apps for entertainment purposes. However, future dating app research should provide direct measures of potential age-related differences in free time and feelings of boredom to further evaluate this idea.

As noted, older age among dating app users was associated with less motivation to gain sexual experience through dating apps. This is consistent with the past research demonstrating less physical intimacy in older age (Kolodziejczak et al., 2019) and less importance placed on sexual attraction in older adults' online dating (Menkin et al., 2015). It also aligns with evidence that older adults become less focused on high-arousal goals and prefer calm and relaxed emotional states (Scheibe et al., 2013). This may be influenced by both biological and social factors. Age-related declines in hormonal activity, physical stamina, and sexual functioning may reduce older adults' interest in casual sexual encounters (Penhollow, 2025). In addition, societal stigma around aging and sexuality may further reduce the relevance of sexual motivations (Stowell et al., 2023). Gender differences in sexual motivations among older adults should also be explored in future studies.

Dating app users who were older reported lower social approval motivation, consistent with previous research suggesting reduced concern with external validation in later life (Tornstam, 1997). This finding also supports the dual-process model of developmental regulation (Brandtstädter & Rothermund, 2002), which describes a developmental shift away from egocentric, individualistic goals toward ego-transcending strivings in older age. An age-related reduction in social approval motivation may also reflect a developmental shift toward greater self-acceptance and autonomy with age (Diehl & Hay, 2010). Older adults tend to rely more on internal emotional resources and value authenticity over external validation (Sheldon & Kasser, 2001), which likely contributes to their lower interest in gaining approval through dating platforms.

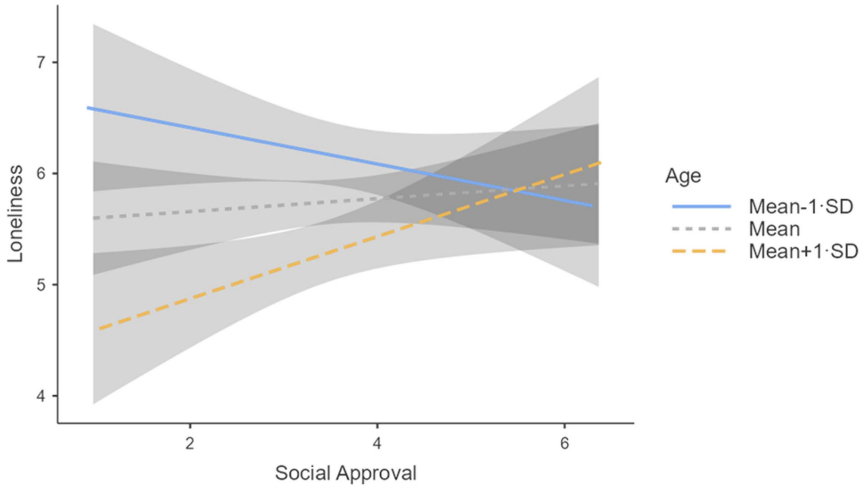
Table 5
Age and Dating Motivations as Predictors of Loneliness

Predictor	β	95% CI		*B*	*p*
		LL	*UL*		
Age	−0.23	−0.34	−0.11	−0.02	**<.001**
Social approval	0.02	−0.10	0.14	0.04	.694
Relationship seeking	0.10	−0.02	0.23	0.14	.093
Sexual experience	−0.02	−0.15	0.11	−0.02	.750
Socializing	0.01	−0.12	0.14	0.02	.850
Entertainment	0.02	−0.12	0.17	0.03	.756
Age × Social approval	0.13	0.01	0.24	0.01	**.031**
Age × Relationship seek	0.10	−0.02	0.22	0.01	.100
Age × Sexual experience	0.01	−0.12	0.14	0.00	.832
Age × Socializing	−0.04	−0.17	0.09	0.00	.554
Age × Entertainment	0.03	−0.11	0.17	0.00	.677

Note. Significant values appear in bold. CI = confidence interval; *LL* = lower limit; *UL* = upper limit.

Figure 1

Age Moderates the Association Between Social Approval Motivation and Loneliness



Note. Simple slopes are shown for mean age −1 *SD* (i.e., younger adults), mean age, and mean age +1 *SD* (i.e., older adults). Shading represents standard error of the mean. See the online article for the color version of this figure.

Dating App Motivations, Older Age, and Well-Being

Among dating app users, older age was associated with more positive well-being, including higher life satisfaction, lower levels of loneliness, and fewer depressive and anxiety symptoms. This counterintuitive pattern reflects what is often referred to as the well-being "paradox" (Hansen & Blekesaune, 2022), in which older adults report stable or even improved life satisfaction despite age-related declines in physical and social resources. This paradox underscores the role of enhanced emotional regulation, a selective focus on emotionally meaningful goals, and a greater ability to downregulate exposure to stress in supporting well-being across later life (Carstensen et al., 2020; Charles et al., 2023; Christopher & Facal, 2023).

Contrary to our hypotheses, relationship seeking and entertainment motivations did not predict depression or loneliness among older dating app users after controlling for other potential predictors.

Table 6

Age and Dating Motivations as Predictors of Depressive Symptoms

Predictor	β	95% CI		B	*p*
		LL	*UL*		
Age	−0.33	−0.44	−0.22	−0.10	**<.001**
Social approval	−0.05	−0.16	0.06	−0.23	.395
Relationship seeking	0.11	−0.01	0.23	0.41	.063
Sexual experience	0.09	−0.03	0.21	0.26	.154
Socializing	0.04	−0.09	0.16	0.15	.551
Entertainment	0.10	−0.03	0.24	0.37	.139
Age × Social approval	0.10	−0.01	0.21	0.03	.063
Age × Relationship seek	0.02	−0.09	0.13	0.00	.699
Age × Sexual experience	−0.07	−0.19	0.06	−0.01	.299
Age × Socializing	−0.06	−0.18	0.07	−0.01	.374
Age × Entertainment	−0.05	−0.19	0.08	−0.01	.443

Note. Significant values appear in bold. CI = confidence interval; *LL* = lower limit; *UL* = upper limit.

However, our hypothesis was based on social media research due to the lack of research examining well-being among older dating app users. It is possible that these dating app motivations reflect adaptive and emotionally meaningful forms of engagement in later life. According to socioemotional selective theory, older adults prioritize social goals that provide emotional meaning, closeness, or companionship (Carstensen, 2021). For those who choose to use dating apps in later life, pursuing romantic connections may therefore align with these preferences rather than threaten well-being. On the other hand, entertainment motivation may be relatively low risk and emotionally neutral, offering casual engagement without substantial emotional investment. Therefore, relationship seeking and entertainment motivations may not be inherently harmful for older dating app users.

The findings for social approval motivation were more nuanced. Greater social approval motivation predicted greater life satisfaction, averaged across age. One potential explanation for this unexpected finding is that seeking social approval may reflect confidence and sociability rather than insecurity. Individuals who are more socially active and outgoing may simply enjoy receiving validation, and dating apps readily provide this through frequent likes, matches, and messages. When dating app users both expect and receive positive social feedback, these experiences can increase self-esteem and, in turn, contribute to higher life satisfaction. This is consistent with research showing that perceived social acceptance continues to shape global self-esteem into early adulthood (Birkeland et al., 2014). However, the process through which social approval motivation contributes to life satisfaction, or vice versa, even in later life remains unclear and warrants further investigation.

Social approval motivation may not always be associated with positive feedback. Among older adults, but not young adults, stronger social approval motivation was linked to greater loneliness. This is consistent with research suggesting that reliance on external validation in later life may come at an emotional cost (e.g.,

Table 7
Age and Dating Motivations as Predictors of Anxiety Symptoms

Predictor	β	95% CI		*B*	*p*
		LL	*UL*		
Age	−0.24	−0.35	−0.14	−0.05	**<.001**
Social approval	0.18	0.05	0.31	0.39	**.006**
Relationship seeking	0.13	0.02	0.25	0.34	**.021**
Sexual experience	0.17	0.05	0.30	0.35	**.006**
Socializing	0.06	−0.06	0.18	0.17	.335
Entertainment	0.05	−0.09	0.19	0.12	.493
Age × Social approval	0.00	−0.12	0.12	0.00	.999
Age × Relationship seek	−0.01	−0.12	0.10	0.00	.834
Age × Sexual experience	0.01	−0.12	0.13	0.00	.919
Age × Socializing	0.02	−0.10	0.14	0.00	.729
Age × Entertainment	−0.12	−0.26	0.02	−0.02	.085

Note. Significant values appear in bold. CI = confidence interval; *LL* = lower limit; *UL* = upper limit.

Diefenbach & Anders, 2021; Elhai et al., 2020; Nesi & Prinstein, 2015). When older dating app users are motivated by social approval, it may heighten feelings of social disconnection, especially when efforts to seek validation are unsuccessful. Older individuals often face barriers to engaging with dating apps in meaningful ways. These include limited familiarity with technology (Neves & Amaro, 2012) and societal biases that favor youthfulness in romantic contexts (Kite et al., 2005). Older adults may struggle with navigating app interfaces, creating appealing profiles, or understanding unspoken norms of digital dating, which younger dating app users generally find intuitive. Furthermore, older adults may prefer more in-depth conversations, whereas communication on dating apps is often fast paced and on surface level. These mismatches may result in unfulfilling interactions, rejection, or feelings of being overlooked, all of which may intensify loneliness in those seeking social approval. The association between social approval motivation and loneliness in older age may also be bidirectional. Greater loneliness may prompt older adults to seek social approval through dating apps, which, in turn, may influence their well-being. This possibility requires examination in future research.

Stronger motivations for social approval, relationship seeking, and sexual experience each predicted higher anxiety symptoms across adulthood, after controlling for other potential predictors. Social approval motivation may have been associated with greater anxiety symptoms because it may not always result in validation. This type of motivation also involves ongoing monitoring of how one is being perceived. In addition, unpredictable responses such as matches or likes place dating app users in contexts of ongoing social evaluation and comparison, which can lead to anxiety when responses are ambiguous or perceived as unsuccessful (Gao et al., 2024; Vogels & Anderson, 2020). Similarly, relationship seeking and sexual experience motivations were associated with higher anxiety symptoms. This may be because these motivations involve emotionally high-stakes interactions characterized by uncertainty, interpersonal risk, and potential rejection. Sexual exploration involves concerns about safety and evaluation, while forming a relationship often involves fear of rejection and substantial emotional investment. For individuals with these motivations, these uncertainties may intensify anticipatory anxiety, even when they do not affect life satisfaction or depressive symptoms during dating app interactions. According to our results, these effects appear to be consistent across the adult lifespan.

Limitations and Future Directions

Several limitations of the present study should be acknowledged. The cross-sectional design limits the ability to draw causal conclusions about the relationships between dating app motivations and psychological outcomes. Although several associations were observed, it remains unclear whether specific motivations directly contribute to mental health outcomes or whether preexisting psychological states influence engagement with dating apps. An important question to be addressed in the future longitudinal research is whether older adults who are lonelier are more likely to seek out social approval on dating apps, and/or whether seeking social approval leads to loneliness among older dating app users. Longitudinal research could also distinguish the effects of aging itself as opposed to age-related differences observed at a single time point. In addition, future research should examine the combined influence of different motivations and dating app usage patterns to gain a better understanding of the relative influence on well-being within different age groups.

The generalizability of the findings is limited by key attributes of the sample, which was predominantly heterosexual, White, English-speaking, highly educated, and employed. These demographic characteristics may not reflect the broader population of dating app users, particularly individuals from diverse cultural, linguistic, or sexual identity backgrounds. For example, in some cultures, dating app use may be normalized and even encouraged, while, in others, it may carry stigma or be considered inappropriate for certain age groups or genders (e.g., Bandinelli, 2022; Cöbek & Ergin, 2021; Menon, 2024). It is also not possible to say whether the current data generalize to users of all dating apps. These apps are typically marketed to different cohorts of daters with different goals. It would therefore be valuable for future research to examine age-related differences in motivations to engage with specific dating apps. As patterns of dating app use and motivations may vary across demographic groups, caution should be taken in generalizing the current findings to all dating app users.

Practical Implications

The present study demonstrated that older dating app users report lower motivation for sexual experiences, social approval, and relationship seeking but higher motivation for socializing. This suggests that many older adults may turn to dating apps to meet new people, chat, and expand their social connection rather than to achieve traditional dating goals. This highlights the importance of developing app features that facilitate nonromantic, social interactions (e.g., interest-based matching, activity-based meetups, and ability to filter matches by social goals).

Our findings also suggest that motivations for relationship seeking and entertainment are not associated with life satisfaction, loneliness, or depressive symptoms, indicating that dating apps may function as a relatively safe avenue for interpersonal connection and leisure activity across adulthood. However, relationship seeking and sexual experience motivations were linked to anxiety symptoms, highlighting the risks for dating app users driven by these types of goals. Moreover, social approval motivation was linked to greater loneliness only among older adults. Platforms should develop features that promote

clear intentions, minimize appearance-based evaluation, and increase safety during interactions (both online and offline). For older adults in particular, the association between approval seeking motivation and loneliness suggests that apps should introduce conversation prompts designed for older adults that highlight hobbies, life experiences, and personal values (e.g., cooking, retirement, and grandparenting). To further promote the well-being of older dating app users, apps could offer profile templates that focus on community connection and interests (e.g., book club matches, walk and talk groups) rather than photos.

Conclusion

The present study provides new insights into how motivations for using dating apps differ across the adult lifespan and how these motivations relate to psychological well-being. In an adult lifespan sample, dating app users who were older were less motivated by social approval, relationship seeking, and sexual experience and more motivated by socializing, reflecting a shift in priorities with age. Moreover, greater social approval motivation predicted greater loneliness among older adults but not younger adults. Providing guidance on how to navigate apps confidently and manage expectations around online feedback (e.g., likes or matches) may help older online daters to feel less lonely. As dating apps continue to attract greater numbers of older users, there is a need to design apps that are sensitive to the differing motivations and diverse needs and well-being of both younger and older adults. App features that are less approval focused and encourage more meaningful interactions, such as conversation prompts, interest-based matching, or less appearance-focused profiles, may help to protect the psychological well-being of older users.

References

An, J., Payne, L. L., Lee, M., & Janke, M. C. (2023). Understanding boredom and leisure in later life: A systematic review. *Innovation in Aging*, *7*(8), Article igad109. https://doi.org/10.1093/geroni/igad109

Bandinelli, C. (2022). Dating apps: Towards post-romantic love in digital societies. *International Journal of Cultural Policy*, *28*(7), 905–919. https://doi.org/10.1080/10286632.2022.2137157

Birkeland, M. S., Breivik, K., & Wold, B. (2014). Peer acceptance protects global self-esteem from negative effects of low closeness to parents during adolescence and early adulthood. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence*, *43*(1), 70–80. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-013-9929-1

Bonsang, E., & Klein, T. J. (2012). Retirement and subjective well-being. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, *83*(3), 311–329. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jebo.2012.06.002

Brandtstädter, J., & Greve, W. (1994). The aging self: Stabilizing and protective processes. *Developmental Review*, *14*(1), 52–80. https://doi.org/10.1006/drev.1994.1003

Brandtstädter, J., & Rothermund, K. (2002). The life-course dynamics of goal pursuit and goal adjustment: A two-process framework. *Developmental Review*, *22*(1), 117–150. https://doi.org/10.1006/drev.2001.0539

Brandtstädter, J., Rothermund, K., Kranz, D., & Kühn, W. (2010). Final decentrations. *European Psychologist*, *15*(2), 152–163. https://doi.org/10.1027/1016-9040/a000019

Carstensen, L. L. (2021). Socioemotional selectivity theory: The role of perceived endings in human motivation. *The Gerontologist*, *61*(8), 1188–1196. https://doi.org/10.1093/geront/gnab116

Carstensen, L. L., Isaacowitz, D. M., & Charles, S. T. (1999). Taking time seriously: A theory of socioemotional selectivity. *American Psychologist*, *54*(3), 165–181. https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066x.54.3.165

Carstensen, L. L., Shavit, Y. Z., & Barnes, J. T. (2020). Age advantages in emotional experience persist even under threat from the COVID-19 pandemic. *Psychological Science*, *31*(11), 1374–1385. https://doi.org/10.1177/0956797620967261

Castro, Á., & Barrada, J. R. (2020). Dating apps and their sociodemographic and psychosocial correlates: A systematic review. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, *17*(18), Article 6500. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph17186500

Charles, S. T., Rush, J., Piazza, J. R., Cerino, E. S., Mogle, J., & Almeida, D. M. (2023). Growing old and being old: Emotional well-being across adulthood. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, *125*(2), 455–469. https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000453

Christopher, G., & Facal, D. (2023). Editorial: Emotion regulation and mental health in older adults. *Frontiers in Psychology*, *14*, Article 1173314. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2023.1173314

Cöbek, G., & Ergin, M. (2021). Swipe me if you can: Cultural and gendered uses of Tinder in Turkey. *International Journal of Social and Humanities Sciences*, *5*(3), 11–38. https://izlik.org/JA57FF33XY

Cotten, S. R., Schuster, A. M., & Seifert, A. (2021). Social media use and well-being among older adults. *Current Opinion in Psychology*, *45*, Article 101293. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2021.12.005

Diefenbach, S., & Anders, L. (2021). The psychology of likes: Relevance of feedback on Instagram and relationship to self-esteem and social status. *Psychology of Popular Media*, *11*(2), 196–207. https://doi.org/10.1037/ppm0000360

Diehl, M., & Hay, E. L. (2010). Risk and resilience factors in coping with daily stress in adulthood: The role of age, self-concept incoherence, and personal control. *Developmental Psychology*, *46*(5), 1132–1146. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0019937

Diener, E., Emmons, R. A., Larsen, R. J., & Griffin, S. (1985). The Satisfaction with Life Scale. *Journal of Personality Assessment*, *49*(1), 71–75. https://doi.org/10.1207/s15327752jpa4901_13

Dominguez-Vergara, J., Aguilar-Salcedo, B., Orihuela-Anaya, R., & Villanueva-Alvarado, J. (2024). New psychometric evidence of the Life Satisfaction Scale in older adults: An exploratory graph analysis approach. *Geriatrics*, *9*(5), Article 111. https://doi.org/10.3390/geriatrics9050111

Elhai, J. D., Rozgonjuk, D., Alghraibeh, A. M., Levine, J. C., Alafnan, A. A., Aldraiweesh, A. A., Aljomaa, S. S., & Hall, B. J. (2020). Excessive reassurance seeking mediates relations between rumination and problematic smartphone use. *Bulletin of the Menninger Clinic*, *84*(2), 137–155. https://doi.org/10.1521/bumc_2020_84_07

Faul, F., Erdfelder, E., Buchner, A., & Lang, A. G. (2009). Statistical power analyses using G*Power 3.1: Tests for correlation and regression analyses. *Behavior Research Methods*, *41*(4), 1149–1160. https://doi.org/10.3758/BRM.41.4.1149

Gao, H., Yin, H., Zheng, Z., & Wang, H. (2024). Online dating apps and the association with emotional reactions: A survey on the motivations, compulsive use, and subjective online success of Chinese young adults in online dating. *Cyberpsychology: Journal of Psychosocial Research on Cyberspace*, *18*(3), Article 3. https://doi.org/10.5817/CP2024-3-3

Hansen, T., & Blekesaune, M. (2022). The age and well-being "paradox": A longitudinal and multidimensional reconsideration. *European Journal of Ageing*, *19*(4), 1277–1286. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10433-022-00709-y

Henry, J. D., & Crawford, J. R. (2005). The short-form version of the Depression Anxiety Stress Scales (DASS-21): Construct validity and normative data in a large non-clinical sample. *The British Journal of Clinical Psychology*, *44*(2), 227–239. https://doi.org/10.1348/014466505X29657

Her, Y.-C., & Timmermans, E. (2021). Tinder blue, mental flu? Exploring the associations between Tinder use and well-being. *Information, Communication & Society*, *24*(9), 1303–1319. https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118x.2020.1764606

Hughes, M. E., Waite, L. J., Hawkley, L. C., & Cacioppo, J. T. (2004). A short scale for measuring loneliness in large surveys: Results from two

population-based studies. *Research on Aging*, *26*(6), 655–672. https://doi.org/10.1177/0164027504268574

Hülür, G., & Macdonald, B. (2020). Rethinking social relationships in old age: Digitalization and the social lives of older adults. *American Psychologist*, *75*(4), 554–566. https://doi.org/10.1037/amp0000604

Isaacowitz, D. M., Freund, A. M., Mayr, U., Rothermund, K., & Tobler, P. N. (2021). Age-related changes in the role of social motivation: Implications for healthy aging. *The Journals of Gerontology: Series B*, *76*(Suppl. 2), S115–S124. https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbab032

Kite, M. E., Stockdale, G. D., Whitley, B. E., & Johnson, B. T. (2005). Attitudes toward younger and older adults: An updated meta-analytic review. *Journal of Social Issues*, *61*(2), 241–266. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-4560.2005.00404.x

Kolodziejczak, K., Rosada, A., Drewelies, J., Düzel, S., Eibich, P., Tegeler, C., Wagner, G. G., Beier, K. M., Ram, N., Demuth, I., Steinhagen-Thiessen, E., & Gerstorf, D. (2019). Sexual activity, sexual thoughts, and intimacy among older adults: Links with physical health and psychosocial resources for successful aging. *Psychology and Aging*, *34*(3), 389–404. https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000347

Liang, R. (2025, December 17). *Motivations for dating app use and well-being across the adult lifespan*. Open Science Framework. https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/9AHPY

Lovibond, S. H., & Lovibond, P. F. (1995). *Depression Anxiety Stress Scales* [Database record]. PsycTESTS. https://doi.org/10.1037/t01004-000

Menkin, J. A., Robles, T. F., Wiley, J. F., & Gonzaga, G. C. (2015). Online dating across the life span: Users' relationship goals. *Psychology and Aging*, *30*(4), 987–993. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0039722

Menon, D. (2024). The Bumble motivations framework- exploring a dating App's uses by emerging adults in India. *Heliyon*, *10*(3), Article e24819. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2024.e24819

Nesi, J., & Prinstein, M. J. (2015). Using social media for social comparison and feedback-seeking: Gender and popularity moderate associations with depressive symptoms. *Journal of Abnormal Child Psychology*, *43*(8), 1427–1438. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10802-015-0020-0

Neves, B. B., & Amaro, F. (2012). Too old for technology? How the elderly of lisbon use and perceive ICT. *The Journal of Community Informatics*, *8*(1), 1–12. https://doi.org/10.15353/joci.v8i1.3061

Pavot, W., & Diener, E. (2008). The Satisfaction with Life Scale and the emerging construct of life satisfaction. *The Journal of Positive Psychology*, *3*(2), 137–152. https://doi.org/10.1080/17439760701756946

Penhollow, T. M. (2025). Sexuality in older adults: Comprehensive strategies for clinicians and patient-centered care. *American Journal of Lifestyle Medicine*, *19*(3), 392–402. https://doi.org/10.1177/15598276241293100

Rosenfeld, M. J., Thomas, R. J., & Hausen, S. (2019). Disintermediating your friends: How online dating in the United States displaces other ways of meeting. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *116*(36), 17753–17758. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1908630116

Ruggiero, T. E. (2000). Uses and gratifications theory in the 21st century. *Mass Communication and Society*, *3*(1), 3–37. https://doi.org/10.1207/s15327825mcs0301_02

Scheibe, S., English, T., Tsai, J. L., & Carstensen, L. L. (2013). Striving to feel good: Ideal affect, actual affect, and their correspondence across adulthood. *Psychology and Aging*, *28*(1), 160–171. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0030561

Sheldon, K. M., & Kasser, T. (2001). Getting older, getting better? Personal strivings and psychological maturity across the life span. *Developmental Psychology*, *37*(4), 491–501. https://doi.org/10.1037/0012-1649.37.4.491

Smith, A., & Duggan, M. (2013, October 21). *Online dating & relationships*. Pew Research Center. https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/2013/10/21/online-dating-relationships-3/

Stephure, R. J., Boon, S. D., MacKinnon, S. L., & Deveau, V. L. (2009). Internet initiated relationships: Associations between age and involvement in online dating. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, *14*(3), 658–681. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1083-6101.2009.01457.x

Stevic, A., Lee, A. Y., Liu, S. X., & Hancock, J. (2025). Of loving and losing: The influence of dating app motivations and perceived success on psychological well-being. *Social Media + Society*, *11*(2). https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051251346888

Stowell, M., Hall, A., Warwick, S., Richmond, C., Eastaugh, C. H., Hanratty, B., McDermott, J., Craig, D., & Spiers, G. (2023). Promoting sexual health in older adults: Findings from two rapid reviews. *Maturitas*, *177*, Article 107795. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.maturitas.2023.107795

Sumter, S. R., Vandenbosch, L., & Ligtenberg, L. (2017). Love me Tinder: Untangling emerging adults' motivations for using the dating application Tinder. *Telematics and Informatics*, *34*(1), 67–78. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tele.2016.04.009

The jamovi project. (2025). *jamovi* (Version 2.6) [Computer software]. https://www.jamovi.org

Timmermans, E., & Courtois, C. (2018). From swiping to casual sex and/or committed relationships: Exploring the experiences of Tinder users. *The Information Society*, *34*(2), 59–70. https://doi.org/10.1080/01972243.2017.1414093

Timmermans, E., & De Caluwé, E. (2017). To Tinder or not to Tinder, that's the question: An individual differences perspective to Tinder use and motives. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *110*(1), 74–79. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2017.01.026

Tornstam, L. (1997). Gerotranscendence: The contemplative dimension of aging. *Journal of Aging Studies*, *11*(2), 143–154. https://doi.org/10.1016/s0890-4065(97)90018-9

Vandeweerd, C., Myers, J., Coulter, M., Yalcin, A., & Corvin, J. (2016). Positives and negatives of online dating according to women 50+. *Journal of Women & Aging*, *28*(3), 259–270. https://doi.org/10.1080/08952841.2015.1137435

Vogels, E., & Anderson, M. (2020, May 8). *Dating and relationships in the digital age*. Pew Research Center. https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/2020/05/08/dating-and-relationships-in-the-digital-age/

Received September 26, 2025
Revision received February 10, 2026
Accepted February 12, 2026 ■